action (it has still not recognized the so-called Central Tibetan Administration, as the government-in-exile came to be called).

Despite these signs of obstreperousness over Tibet just after the 1962 war, Delhi maintained a dual and ambivalent stance towards the Dalai Lama. He was, by and large, restricted to Dharamshala, to manage religious and community affairs. On the other hand, over time, as he attracted greater international attention, India issued a special document to enable him to travel. He made his first trip to the West in 1973 and to the US in 1979. From 1987, he travelled abroad at least once a year, and between 1954 and 2000 he made 183 trips to 57 countries.[108] Whatever India's concerns about his actions and China's annoyance at his increasing international popularity, legally and morally Delhi had little choice. Also, his increasing following in the West made it difficult to curb his movements. China remained sensitive to the Dalai Lama's presence in India and his international activities. It repeatedly asked India to curb him. In 1978, it also established direct contact with the Tibetan leader. The Dalai Lama responded by sending delegations to Tibet from 1979 to 1982.[109] In September 1993, he clarified that he looked to a 'solution [with Beijing] which does not ask for independence of Tibet'.[110]

Delhi's response to Beijing's nervousness and outreach to the Dalai Lama was to support China's ownership of Tibet, beginning with the joint press communiqué of 23 December 1988 at the conclusion of Rajiv Gandhi's visit to China. A series of reassuring Indian statements followed: the final communiqué at the conclusion of Premier Li Peng's visit in 2001, the Declaration on Principles for Relations and Comprehensive Co-operation signed on 23 June 2003, the joint statement of 11 April 2005, and the joint declaration signed during Hu Jintao's visit to India on 21 November 2006. All these statements refer to China's ownership of Tibet. In 1988, when Rajiv Gandhi had visited China, the joint communiqué had said that India recognized Tibet as 'an autonomous region of China'. By 2003, when Vajpayee visited China, India went even further. The communiqué stated that 'the Tibet Autonomous Region is part of the